

FESTIVALS AND GAMES

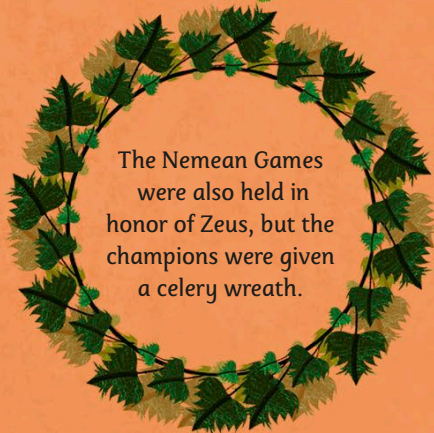
Festivals and athletic games were held in honor of the gods. Festivals often involved dancing, sacrifices, and theater. Big athletic games were held regularly, such as the Olympic Games held every four years. Winners were awarded wreaths—crowns made from leaves.



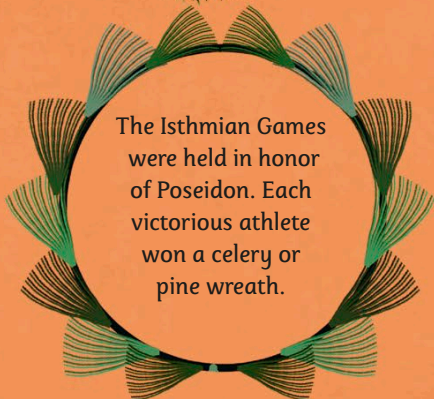
The Pythian Games were held in honor of Apollo, and athletes could win a laurel wreath.



The Olympic Games were held in honor of Zeus, and the winners received a wreath of olive leaves.



The Nemean Games were also held in honor of Zeus, but the champions were given a celery wreath.



The Isthmian Games were held in honor of Poseidon. Each victorious athlete won a celery or pine wreath.

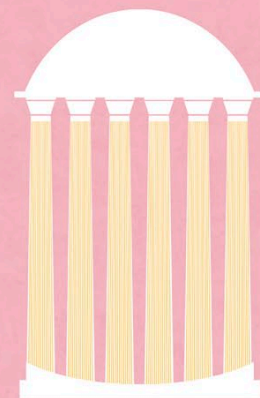
WORSHIPING THE GODS

Religion was a huge part of every ancient Greek's life. People had small shrines at home where they would worship the gods and offer sacrifices, but they also took part in large public celebrations. Athletic games and festivals in sacred places were common and often dedicated to specific gods.



SACRED PLACES

There were lots of different kinds of sacred places all over Greece. Certain towns or islands were associated with a particular god or goddess.



A secret festival dedicated to Demeter and Persephone was held in the town of Eleusis.

Delphi was where the famous priestess of Apollo, the Pythia, lived. People would visit her to hear the future.

